that I am getting older; my last four birthdays I have spent in prison, here and in Dehra D u n Jail, and m a n y others in the

** Chorus from 'The Bacchae of Euripides. Gilbert Murray's translation.*



course of my previous terms of imprisonment. I have lost count of their number.

During all these months I have often thought of writing, **felt** the urge to it and at the same time a reluctance. My friends **took** it for granted that I would write and produce another book, as I h a d done during previous terms of imprisonment. It h a d almost become a habit.

Yet I did not write. There was a certain distaste for just throwing out a book which had no particular significance. It was easy enough to write, but to write something that was worth while was another matter, something that would not grow stale while I sat in prison with my manuscript and the world went on changing. I would not be writing for to-day or to-morrow but for an unknown and possibly distant future. For -whom would I write? and for when? Perhaps what I wrote would never be published, for the years **1** would spend in prison **were**